



Figure 1: The Android Emulator on android-emulator.org



Figure 2: mashable.com on Android Emulator

It is very important for mobile app developers to understand the difference between these. Another intriguing fact regarding this topic is that Apple provides a simulator for the iPhone and iPad, whereas Android provides an emulator.

In this article, I'll discuss two Web-based approaches to quick testing of mobile Web apps or hybrid mobile apps. First, let's look at a minimalistic Web tool. It can be accessed using any of the following URLs: <http://android-emulator.org/>, <http://iphone-emulator.org/>, <http://ipad-emulator.org/> and <http://blackberry-emulator.org/> or <http://tablet-emulator.org/>. All these URLs will take you to a Web page like the one shown in Figure 1. This is a very minimalistic tool that can be used for quickly testing your CSS media queries. It should be noted that this tool is a simulator, even though the URLs and the website titles claim it is an emulator. In the address bar of the browser that is open in the simulator, you can type in your website's address, hosted locally or on the Internet, to open it up. For instance, refer to Figures 2 and 3 where I've opened up <http://www.mashable.com> to see how its media queries are working. Figure 4 shows the actual site on a laptop browser, Figure 3 shows it on an iPad and Figure 2 shows it on an Android browser. If you observe carefully, you'll be able to see that the site is pretty responsive, and the content is automatically adapting to the screen sizes. Though this is a pretty minor use case, at times this is enough for the developers to test the mobile



Figure 3: mashable.com on iPad Emulator



Figure 4: mashable.com on a laptop browser

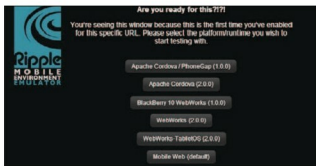


Figure 5: Ripple Emulator platform and runtime support

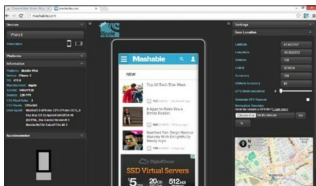


Figure 6: mashable.com on iPhone5 in Ripple with device details and other emulation support

Web app. It is, however, a very limited tool, and also has a lot of unwanted things around the simulator.